

Creative Inspire 5700D

Something for everyone

Creative's Inspire 5700D comes with an external Digital decoder, and is filled to the brim with features not seen on any other speaker in this comparison.

It comes in classy black, and has excellent build quality. The four satellites and the unusually large, curved centre speaker are made of plastic, but the sub-woofer is made of wood, lending great depth and punch to the bass. The sub-woofer isn't ported, and hence offers tight and deep bass output that doesn't distort at high volumes. The most enticing feature of this speaker is the supplied decoder. The decoder allows you to discretely control the output of centre and rear satellites, as well as the sub-woofer, thus offering better hardware control over various outputs. The 'Effect' button presents the select predefined modes of music, movie, four point and stereo. You can also choose between Dolby Digital, Dolby Pro Logic and DTS output. The decoder also has three types of inputs—Analogue, Digital DIN, and both SPDIF coaxial and Optical. All the connectors are gold plated.

A full-featured infra-red remote is bundled, and you can control all the features mentioned above with it. The package includes a Digital DIN cable, SPDIF Optical cable, coaxial cable, speaker stands and power adapter.

There is accuracy in the sound; the bass and treble are clean. It is good for listening to music, watching movies and playing games. With six speakers and maximum total power-handling capacity, the sound is enough for your 10 x 12 sq ft room. If you are interested in clear sound reproduction, these speakers are the best.

— NISSAR ALI CHIKATE



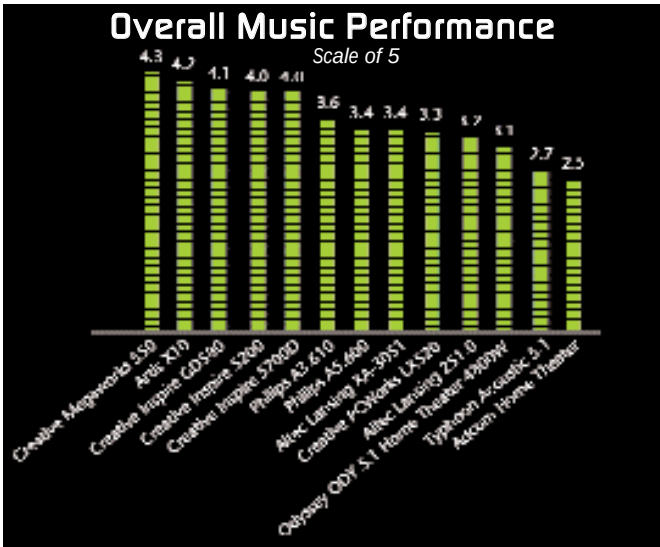
We connected the speaker using the SPDIF optical, as this offers the best quality. On the performance front, the speaker was simply fantastic. In the gaming tests, the bass was perfect, with not a hint of distortion—even at full volume. At high volumes, the highs seemed clipped. In the DVD test, the effects were superbly reproduced; but due to the limited RMS power, it was not as impressive as the Megaworks 550. In the music test, the overall frequency response was acceptable, especially the treble response. In the special frequency test, all tones were reproduced distinctly, without any audible harmonics.

At Rs 23,999, the Inspire 5700D is the same price as the Megaworks 550, which made our final decision harder. If you're a gamer, and want deep thumping bass, the Megaworks 550 is your answer. If you're an audiophile, nothing beats the versatility that the Inspire 5700D offers, with various input options and remote control.

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Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 23,999
+ Superb clarity
- Comparitively low power



In the Hindi audio test, we just didn't want to test any other speakers after listening to the Creative 5700D play. If you overlook its lower RMS output, this is the perfect speaker system.

In the DVD-audio test, we had to connect to the analogue out of the DVD, and not the digital out. The Megaworks led the pack here, and the same went for the MP3 tests. There was only a difference of a couple of points between all the speakers.

The audio frequency file tests sent the entire test scurrying for ear plugs. The Philips duo shone in this category, and tied with the Creative and Altec Lansing speakers. The Adcom seemed to suffer from acoustic diarrhoea, and we got a few angry shouts from across the office.

Manuals and documentation

All the speakers that we received had some form or the other, of documentation—be it verbose manuals, or quick start guides. The Creative 5700D and the Creative GD580 had extensive manuals, in addition to the quick

